COLLEGE DE PARIS SUPERIEUR

Session 2: Professional Email Writing

Bachelor 1 – Business English for IT Professionals



Dorcas Tchogoue

“The Reply All Disaster”



“hey guys, the server thing is late lol. thx.”



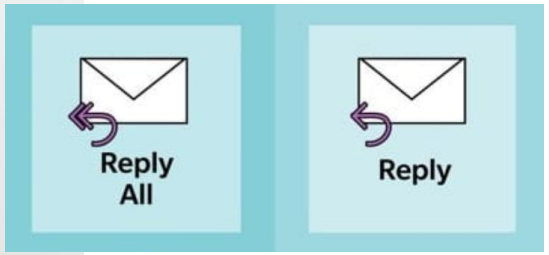
“Leo – please follow email etiquette.”



ZOE

“Zoe, stop being so bossy.”



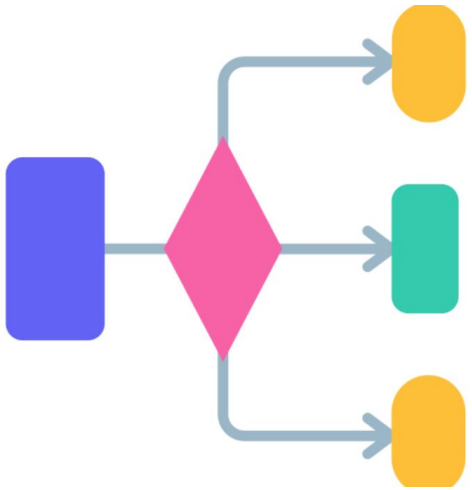


SESSION 2: Professional Email Writing

Objectives:

- ❖ Identify and label the 5 key components of a professional email.
- ❖ Write clear, polite emails for common IT work situations.
- ❖ Distinguish between formal and semi-formal tone based on the recipient.
- ❖ Avoid common email mistakes.
- ❖ Revise and improve a poorly written email through peer feedback.
- ❖ Use 5+ business vocabulary words from Session 1 appropriately in email contexts.

Goals



1) Learners write at least 3 complete professional emails independently.
2) Learners identify and fix 5+ common email errors.
3) Learners leave with templates they can use at work.

Why Email Skills Matter for IT

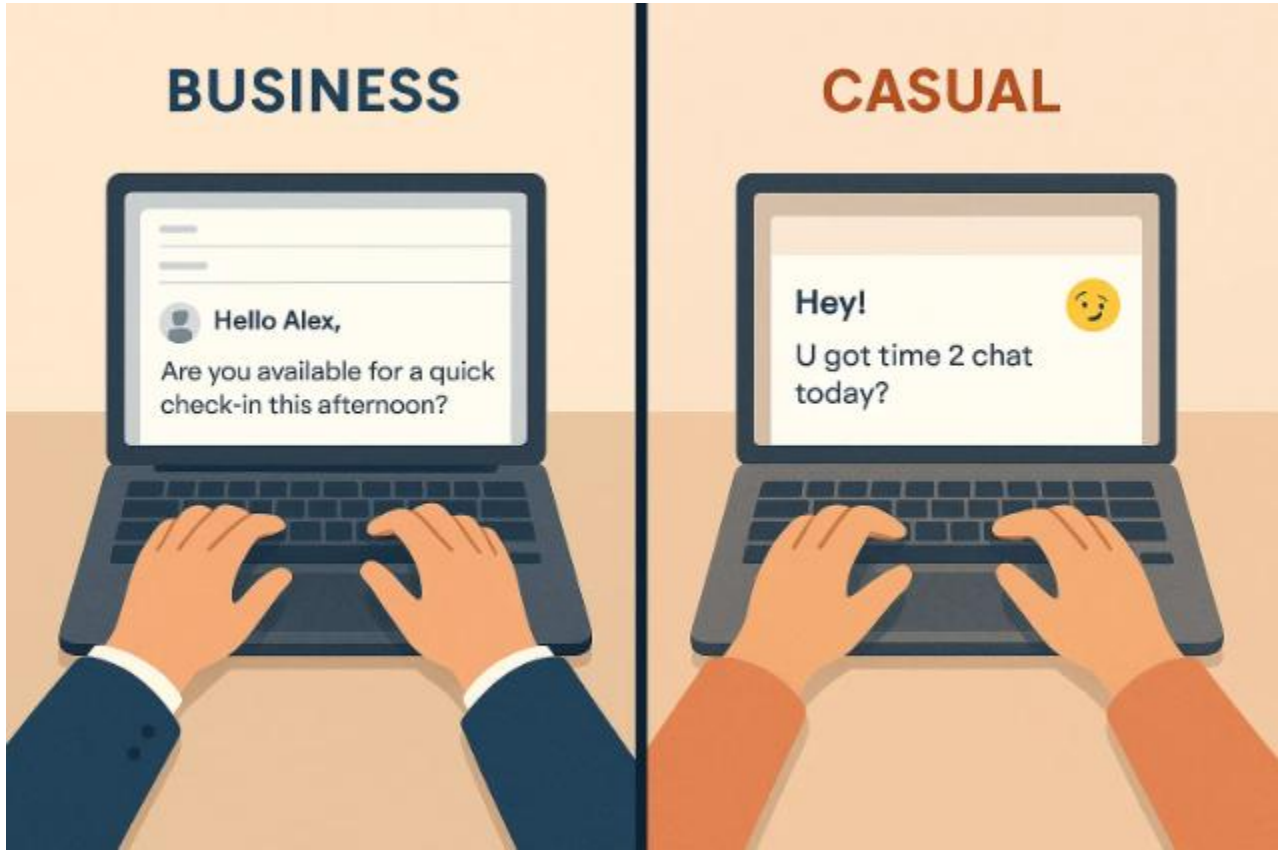
- Clients judge you by your emails.

A bad email = confusion, delays, angry bosses.

Discussion:

"What's the worst email you've ever received?"

(Pair discussion – 2 min)



Email Anatomy – 5 Parts

1. Subject line
2. Salutation (greeting)
3. Body
4. Closing
5. Signature

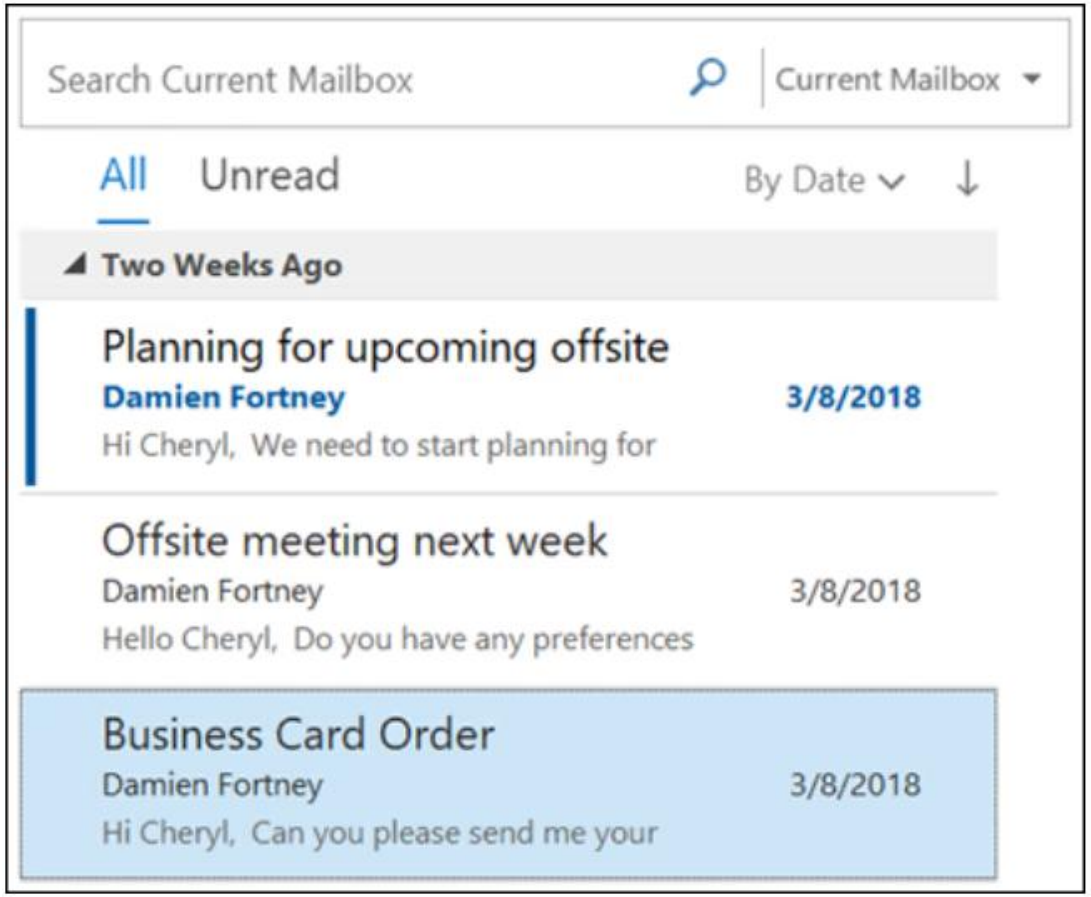


Subject Lines – Make or Break

Bad: "Hello" / "Problem" / (empty).
Good: "Q3 Budget Update – Action Needed by Friday"

Exercise:
Rewrite these bad subject lines:

"Meeting"
"Issue with server"
"Hello"



Subject Lines – Make or Break

Bad: "Hello" / "Problem" / (empty).
Good: "Q3 Budget Update – Action Needed by Friday"

Exercise:
Rewrite these bad subject lines:

"Meeting" ➢ "Project Kickoff – Wed 10am"
"Issue with server" ➢ "Server Outage – Urgent"
"Hello" ➢ "Introduction – New IT Team Member"

Salutations – Who Are You Writing To?

- **Formal** (new client, boss you don't know well):

Dear Mr. Smith,

- **Semi-formal** (colleague, regular client):

Hello Sarah, / Hi John,

- Never: Hey dude, / Yo,

Exercise: Choose the right salutation for:

- CEO of a big company
- Your teammate
- A long-term client.

Body – The CLEAR Method

C	**Context** (why are you writing?)
L	**Logistics** (what, when, where?)
E	**Expectation** (what do you need?)
A	**Action** (what should they do?)
R	**Respect** (thank you)

Exercise:

Identify each part in an example email.



Body – The CLEAR Method

Example Email

Subject: Budget Approval Needed for Server Upgrade

Dear Ms. Rivera,

We are planning to upgrade our main server next month because the current one is too slow and affects daily work.
The upgrade will cost €5,000 and will take place on Saturday, June 10th, from 8 AM to 2 PM.
I need your approval before Friday, June 2nd, so we can schedule the vendor.
Could you please review the attached quote and reply with your approval?

Thank you for your support.

Best regards,

Thomas Lee
IT Manager



Body – The CLEAR Method

Exercise: Identify Each CLEAR Part

Write the letter (C, L, E, A, or R) next to each sentence from the email.

1. "We are planning to upgrade our main server next month because the current one is too slow and affects daily work." | _____ |
2. "The upgrade will cost €5,000 and will take place on Saturday, June 10th, from 8 AM to 2 PM." | _____ |
3. "I need your approval before Friday, June 2nd, so we can schedule the vendor." | _____ |
4. "Could you please review the attached quote and reply with your approval?" | _____ |
5. "Thank you for your support." | _____ |

1- C (Context)| Explains why writing (server is too slow) |
2- L (Logistics)| Gives cost, date, time (what, when, where) |
3- E (Expectation)| States what is needed (approval by June 2nd) |
4- A (Action)| Tells what reader should do (review + reply) |
5- R (Respect)| Polite thank you |

Write your own email and label each CLEAR part

Subject: _____

Dear _____,

C (Context): _____

L (Logistics): _____

E (Expectation): _____

A (Action):_____

R (Respect): _____

Best regards,

[Your Name]



Closing Lines – Polite & Professional

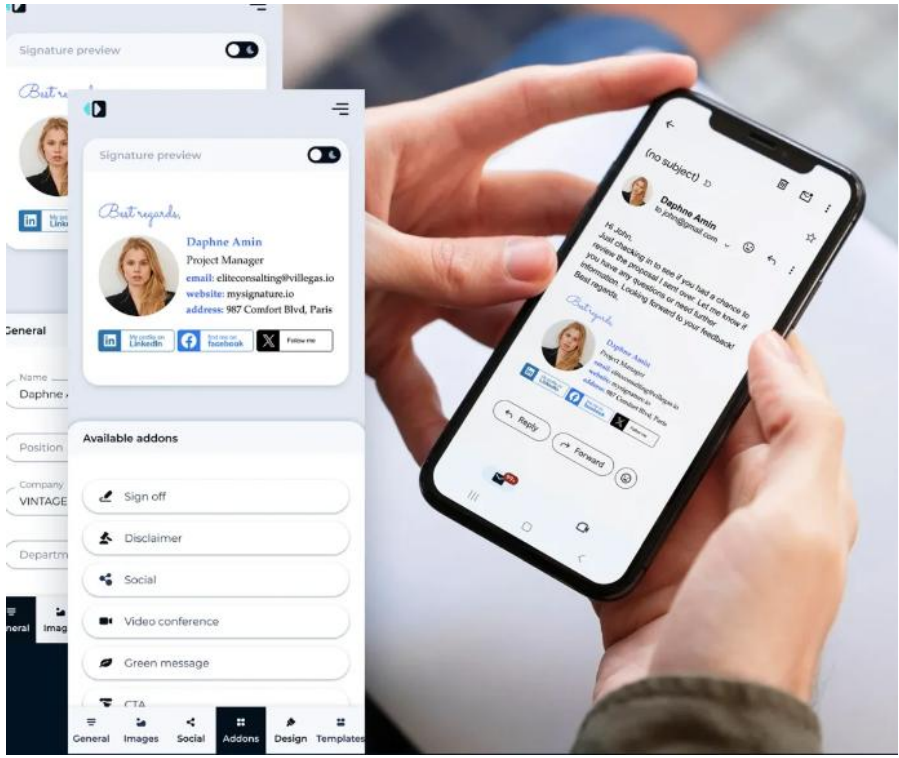
- Best regards, (standard)
- Kind regards, (friendly)
- Sincerely, (formal)
- Looking forward to your reply,
- Never: Cheers, / Later, / XOXO



Exercise: *Match closing to situation (boss / client / close colleague).*

Signatures – Your Digital Business Card

- Name
- Job title
- Company
- Phone (optional)
- Never: quotes, emojis, giant images



Exercise:

Create your own professional signature in 2 minutes.



Formal vs. Semi-Formal
Know Your Audience

- To boss: "Could you please review the attached report?"
- To colleague: "Can you check the attachment?"
- To client: "I would appreciate it if you could..."

Exercise:

Rewrite a casual email to be formal.

Subject: hi
Hey Jen,
Can you send me that file? Need it by tomorrow. Gonna be late otherwise.
Thanks!
Tom



Example of a Good Formal Rewrite:

Subject: File Request – Deadline Tomorrow

Dear Jen,

Could you please send me the file? I need it by tomorrow to avoid missing the deadline.

Thank you for your help.

Best regards,

Tom



Things to change:
- Subject line
- Salutation
- Tone (no "gonna," "hey," etc.)
- Grammar and punctuation
- Closing and signature

Subject: hi
Hey Jen,
Can you send me that file? Need it by tomorrow. Gonna be late otherwise.
Thanks!
Tom

Disaster Email #1 – No Subject Line

Example:
(empty subject) **"Hey, there's a problem. Call me."** Wrong
– What's wrong?



Discussion:

Why is this email ineffective?
(2 min)

Rewrite Subject line:

Disaster Email #1 – No Subject Line

Example: "Hey, there's a problem. Call me." Wrong

"Server Issue – Please Call When Available" Right



Disaster Email #2 – Reply All Nightmare

"Reply all" to 200 people with "Stop sending emails!!!"

- True stories welcome

Warning: Reply all is a weapon. Use carefully.



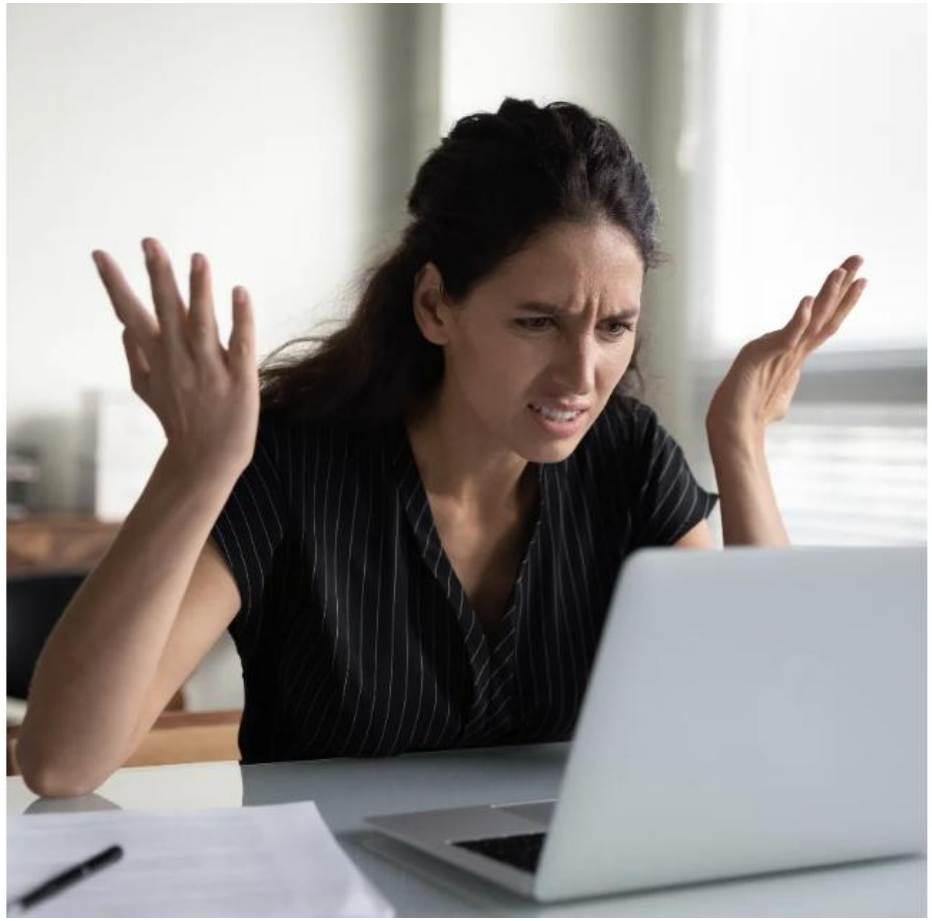
Disaster Email #3 – Too Casual

"Yo team, gonna need that thing by tomorrow. k thx."

Wrong

– Why is this bad?

Rewrite Subject line:



Disaster Email #3 – Too Casual

"Yo team, gonna need that thing by tomorrow. k thx."

Wrong

"Dear team, the deadline for the report is tomorrow. Thank you for your efforts."

Right



Using Session 1 Vocabulary in Emails

Words to use:

- attached,
- deadline,
- stakeholder,
- touch base,
- budget,
- sprint,
- UAT

Exercise: Write one sentence using any 3 words



Guided Writing – Project Delay Email

Scenario: Sprint delayed by 2 days

- Write email to manager

  Must include: subject line, salutation, reason, new deadline, apology, closing

Time: 10 minutes



Peer Review – Friendly Feedback



Swap emails with a partner.

Check:

- Subject line present?
- Clear request?
- Polite tone?
- No spelling errors?

Time: 10 minutes

Rewrite the Disaster Email (Group Activity)



Disaster: "u there? need file. send quick. thx."

Wrong

Teams rewrite together
Best version wins

Time: 10 minutes + sharing.

Email Race – 3 Emails in 20 Minutes

1. Meeting request to a client
2. Follow-up after meeting
3. Apology for a mistake

Goal: Speed + clarity



Common Email Mistakes to Avoid

- ALL CAPS (shouting) ❌
- No greeting or closing ❌
- Forgetting attachment ❌
- Emojis in business emails 😬 ❌
- "Sent from my iPhone" (too casual for clients) ❌

Homework

1. Write 3 real or practice emails:
   meeting request, follow-up, apology.
2. Find one good business email you
   received (anonymize it) and bring
   to next class.
3. Prepare a 2-minute presentation for Session 3: "An IT problem I once solved."



Instruction: To be completed in your notebook before next class.
Note: This work is compulsory.
Students without completed homework at the start of class will receive a 2-mark deduction.

Review and Reflection

- What have you learned today?
- Share one thing you learned and how you will apply it





Preview of Session 3 . . .

Next Time: Oral Presentations in a Business Context

- Learn how to structure a short business presentation.
- Use transition phrases (First, Next, Finally, To summarize).
- Practice explaining a technical problem to a non-technical audience.
- Receive feedback on clarity, pace, and confidence.



Some valuable resources:

Recommended Book

Title: Email English (Macmillan – 2nd Edition)

Author: Paul Emmerson

Relevant unit: Units 1–6 (Basic phrases, Opening/closing, Requests, Attachments, Apologies)

Why: Real email examples, bad vs. good versions, exercises. Includes IT scenarios.

➢**Lighter Reading**

Title: “How to write a perfect professional email in English” (Guide)

Source: Oxford University Press / English at Work (free PDF online)

Why: Short checklist students can keep on their desk.

➢**Bonus for IT context**

Article: “The 5 worst IT support emails (and how to fix them)”

Source: Search online – many IT blogs have this.

Why: Funny, relatable, teaches through real mistakes.

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Thank you!



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